



WFP DOMINICAN REPUBLIC

COUNTRY BRIEF

July 2026



300 people assisted in June
(51% female)



USD 3.91 M required in the next six
months (July–December 2026)

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- WFP strengthened resilience and preparedness through targeted emergency response, adaptive social protection, climate action and nutrition initiatives. Following floods in northwestern Dominican Republic, WFP identified 1,001 vulnerable households for cash assistance. WFP also advanced adaptive social protection through a national diploma programme and coordination of the Mesa PSA, while promoting climate innovation and strengthening hydrometeorological monitoring capacities. Nutrition efforts focused on food fortification, healthy diets, anticipatory action and food safety, contributing to stronger national systems and improved outcomes for vulnerable populations.

SITUATION OVERVIEW

- The Dominican Republic, like other Small Island Developing States in the Caribbean, is highly exposed to severe weather events such as hurricanes, flooding, and droughts, which disrupt livelihoods, damage infrastructure, and strain food systems. Ecosystem degradation further reduces natural protection against extreme events. Around 25 percent of households are highly vulnerable to climate shocks, disproportionately affecting poor and hazard-prone communities. Territorial inequalities leave rural and border provinces with fewer opportunities and higher poverty rates, while 53.4 percent of employment is informal. Global food price volatility, dependence on remittances, and localized migration pressures compound these risks, intersecting with persistent micronutrient deficiencies and the double burden of malnutrition disproportionately affecting women, children, and excluded groups. These vulnerabilities are exacerbated by global market instability linked to the Middle East crisis, driving food price volatility, energy cost increases, and supply chain disruption, raising concern for national food security and household resilience.
- WFP's strategy links national planning with local action to address recurrent shocks systemically. Evidence and data guide interventions, building government capacity so central decisions translate into community protection. Climate services and risk management tools are embedded in social protection, enabling anticipatory action. Pre-positioning, disaster risk finance ensure rapid response when systems are strained. Platforms such as ANACAONA and the DR–Haiti corridor exemplify collective resilience.

OPERATIONAL UPDATES

Emergency response

- WFP conducted a targeted household assessment in the provinces of Valverde and Monte Cristi following the floods that affected northwestern Dominican Republic in late April, in coordination with Plan International and Civil Defense. 1,253 households were surveyed to identify those most affected and vulnerable, using a prioritization methodology that considered socio-economic vulnerability, household composition, exposure to flood impacts, livelihood losses, social exclusion and the presence of individuals with specific needs. Based on this assessment, 1,001 households were selected to receive cash assistance, ensuring assistance reaches those facing greatest needs.

Adaptive Social Protection

- WFP, through the USG-funded Cuenca Resiliente project and in partnership with INTEC University and UNICEF, launched the first Diploma in Adaptive Social Protection in the Dominican Republic to strengthen national capacities through education and collaboration with academia. The programme provides specialized training on adaptive social protection, disaster risk management, and anticipatory action, fostering a new generation of professionals equipped to address climate-related risks. By institutionalizing this knowledge within national institutions and universities, the initiative is expected to contribute to more resilient and proactive social protection systems.
- WFP convened and supported a High-Level Meeting of the Adaptive Social Protection Technical Working Group (Mesa PSA), bringing together the Social Policy Cabinet (GCPS), SIUBEN, INDOMET, Civil Defense, Supérate, UNDP and other key partners to strengthen coordination on climate risk preparedness. Participants discussed the potential impacts of a forecasted moderate-to-strong El Niño event, including drought risks and pressure on agriculture and water resources, while noting that despite an expected below-average hurricane season, the country remains vulnerable to high-impact storms and flooding. The meeting promoted the use of climate information and anticipatory action approaches, and highlighted the launch of the Dominican Republic's first parametric insurance scheme for social protection. By strengthening

coordination among institutions responsible for social protection, climate services and disaster risk management, the Mesa PSA is helping to align preparedness efforts and support more timely, coordinated and anticipatory responses to climate-related shocks.

Disaster Risk Management and climate change

- WFP, in partnership with the Ministry of Environment and Natural Resources, officially launched the Dominican Republic's participation in the third cohort of the Adaptation Fund Climate Innovation Accelerator (AFCIA), WFP's global climate innovation incubator designed to identify, test and scale innovative solutions to climate adaptation challenges. WFP engaged government institutions, UN agencies, NGOs, foundations and development partners in a collaborative process to identify priority challenges requiring innovative approaches, with a particular focus on food security, disaster risk management and adaptive social protection. By connecting national stakeholders with AFCIA's innovation support platform, the initiative is expected to accelerate the development and scaling of locally driven solutions that strengthen resilience, support climate adaptation and enhance the capacity of vulnerable communities to cope with climate-related risks.
- WFP and the Dominican Institute of Meteorology (INDOMET) delivered a hands-on technical workshop to strengthen institutional capacities in the operational use of ANACAONA, a hydrometeorological monitoring and risk analysis platform that supports anticipatory action and evidence-based decision-making. The training brought together forecasting, research and regional center specialists from INDOMET to enhance their skills in the interpretation of meteorological products, georeferencing of monitoring stations, generation of precipitation maps, and data exchange and validation processes. The workshop strengthened collaboration between WFP and INDOMET, identified priority improvements to the platform. These efforts are expected to improve the quality and accessibility of hydrometeorological information, supporting more timely risk analysis, early warning and anticipatory action to reduce the impacts of climate-related hazards on vulnerable populations.

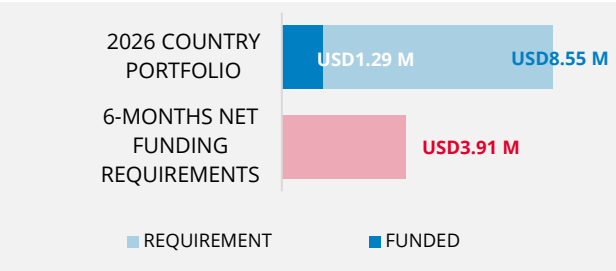
Nutrition

- WFP supported the launch of the Simplified Course on Monitoring Fortified Foods, jointly organized with the Ministry of Public Health and the Food Fortification Technical Committee, comprising the General Directorate of Medicines, Food and Health Products (DIGEMAPS), the Technical Secretariat for Food and Nutrition Security (SETESSAN), the Ministry of Public Health (MISPAS), WFP, and the Institute of Nutrition of Central America and Panama (INCAP). The course will focus on strengthening national capacities to monitor fortified rice and wheat flour, two key vehicles for the delivery of essential micronutrients, while enhancing quality assurance mechanisms across the national food fortification programme. By equipping government institutions with the knowledge and tools required to effectively oversee compliance with fortification standards, the initiative is expected to improve the effectiveness of food fortification efforts and contribute to better nutrition outcomes for vulnerable populations.
- WFP participated in the “Más Salud” Health Fair organized by the Ministry of Public Health in Hermanas Mirabal Province, promoting healthy diets and positive nutrition practices as part of its Social and Behaviour Change (SBC) strategy. Through the interactive storytelling activity “Julie and the Rainbow of Foods,” presented by the character Calife, WFP engaged children and caregivers in learning about dietary diversity, nutritious food choices and healthy eating habits. By using an engaging and family-centered approach to nutrition education, the initiative is expected to reinforce key nutrition messages, encourage the adoption of healthier dietary practices, and contribute to improved nutrition outcomes among vulnerable communities over the long term.
- WFP conducted community outreach sessions in Bajo Yuna as part of the implementation of nutrition-sensitive interventions under its Anticipatory Action Strategy, promoting food security, healthy diets and preparedness measures among vulnerable communities. WFP engaged community members in discussions on nutrition practices and actions that can help reduce the impacts of climate-related shocks on food security and nutritional well-being. By integrating nutrition into anticipatory action programming, the initiative is helping communities strengthen their

preparedness for future shocks, while promoting healthier dietary practices and protecting vulnerable households from the adverse effects of climate-related disruptions.

- WFP participated in the national commemoration of World Food Safety Day alongside the General Directorate of Medicines, Food and Health Products (DIGEMAPS), reaffirming its commitment to strengthening food safety systems and supporting national institutions responsible for ensuring the availability of safe and nutritious food. The event highlighted the importance of robust food safety standards, quality control and regulatory oversight as essential components of food security and nutrition, while recognizing the efforts of national institutions to protect consumers and ensure access to safe and nutritious foods.

FUNDING OVERVIEW
Country Strategic Plan (2024-2028)



Note: 2026 funding refers exclusively to contributions received in 2026.

Donors:
Dominican Republic, DG-ECHO, DSM-Fiermenich, Joint SDG Fund, Systematic Observations Financing Facility (SOFF), United States.

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